

OPTIMAL SCORING STRATEGIES FOR THE LIZARD CULT IN *Root*

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We propose a discrete-time Markov chain framework to model scoring using gardens for the Lizard Cult faction in the asymmetric board game *Root*. The Cult's ability to score from their gardens is affected three different processes with stochasticity introduced by their opponents: suited card draws from a shared deck, the dynamic Outcast suit determined by recently discarded cards, and forcible removal of their gardens. Unlike other factions, the Cult chooses when it will score from its gardens, which allows for significant strategy-based variation. We use Monte Carlo simulation to visualize scoring trajectories and determine which parameters are most key.